

android robot that looks like us and is capable of mimicking our actions and features is still some time away.

How to word 'robot' came to be

The word 'robot' is old and didn't always mean what it does at this age. Robot meant 'forced labour' and was used to refer to the system of slavery spread across central Europe until it was abolished in the year 1848. The word again popped up in the year 1920, when Karel Capek, a Czech writer, wrote a play titled Rossum's Universal Robots. In the play, workers were mass-produced from synthetic organic material and were called robots. Strangely, the play was not only the first instance of robots but also the first popular media to showcase a robot uprising and a dystopian futuristic world. Karel Capek didn't know that his play was going to give birth to a whole new sub-genre of sci-fi where robots take over the world and turn against humanity. I guess we have someone to thank for the

Terminator franchise. Not every robot looks like a humanoid and has arms and legs.

Greek mythology features a number of characters that possess many of the traits of a robot. Hephaestus, the Greek God of craftsmen, made a

three-legged table capable of moving around on its own, and a man-made out of bronze called Talos. Back home, there are legends of King Ajatashatru of Magadha dynasty gathering Buddha's relics and hiding them somewhere underground protected by robots or 'bhuta vahana yantra'. The first documented account of a robot can be traced back to 4th Century BC Greece, where a mathematician called Archytas of Tarentum designed a mechanical bird called 'Pigeon', propelled by steam. Throughout history, there have been many similar designs and mentions of devices that look and work like a robot. Industrial robots led to robots becoming more mainstream. Robots could not only increase efficiency and accuracy, but also reduce the number of workers required. The first robot to be used on a production line was the Unimate Robot. It was first installed in the General Motors, Ternstedt plant in the USA. The robot had a 4,000-pound heavy arm that was programmed to stack hot pieces of metals. Within the next two decades,



Credit: YouTube / Draw Quite